# Deputy Guild Lead 2026 Application

## INSTRUCTIONS

1) Submit your application via email to mathematicsclub_cfi@smail.iitm.ac.in , ee23b058@smail.iitm.ac.in and ee23b180@smail.iitm.ac.in by 11th Feb 2026 EOD.

2) There is no fixed 'answer key' to any of these questions. Feel free to give us any opinion you have (irrespective of how different from ours it may be) but make sure you have analyzed your approach from all angles.

3) Taking fundaes from the following people is compulsory (you can ~~should~~ fundae people outside this group as well)
   - current Guild Captains and Club Heads.
   - 2024-25 tenure guild captains.
   - A majority of current guild members (cover both 24B and 25B).

## I) COMMON

1) List down all new initiatives and changes that you are planning to bring about in this year's tenure.

2) Prepare a non exhaustive list of competitions that your guild will participate in, starting from March 2026 to May 2027.

3) How do you plan to carry forward knowledge transfer between the current members of the guild and incoming members effectively?

4) Adding on, how will you keep the existing guild members/ past contingent members occupied throughout the year considering they won't be doing the beginner tasks set for new incoming members

again? What metric would be used to evaluate them so that it won't hinder your selection process for the contingent?

5) What do you think should be the qualities and qualifications of a contingent strategist? Why do you think you are the best candidate for this role?

6) Do a detailed SWOT analysis of the ongoing (June onwards) Mathematics Guild tenure.

## II) LOGISTICS

1) Suggest an efficient way to keep track of the progress of the guild members. Highlight how it was done during this tenure. What were the associated challenges? Highlight the things that you plan to do differently.

2) Make a **calendar** from March 2026 to May 2027
   - Add all competitions you have mentioned in QI.2
   - Mention general plans (Problem Sets, Teaching sessions or any form of upskilling)
   - Be clear with how often you plan to meet.
   - Take into account factors like prep time needed for the competitions, quizzes, recruitment etc. as they might affect the nature of your plans (i.e specify how your strategy changes in response to these factors)

   **Mark exact dates** in your calendar wherever possible (or range of dates for that particular task). Submit a pdf and include a description in your app.

3) Make a **budget** for the tenure. Specify the amount, reason and tentative date next to each expenditure. Submit an excel sheet.

4) Comment on the effectiveness of **Problem Sets** and how much enthusiasm was shown by the guild overall. Suggest what you can do to tackle the issues faced (if any).

5) Comment on teaching sessions, i.e
    - How frequent you want them to be and on what topics.
    - How will you allocate work between yourselves and the guild members (it is highly improbable that you are a master at every topic or that you will have the time to prepare a lecture every week)
    - What sequence of topics do you think will work, i.e **prepare a lesson plan**. You can ~~should~~ take opinions from guild members.

    - **What resource(s) to follow** (look up well known resources like olympiad prep books or PYQs of competitions. You can list out multiple resources but describe the exact purpose of each (eg, if a competition date is close). Your lesson plan and resource must maximise learning output **while keeping the workload in check**)

6) Can you identify possible collaborations with other guilds or other bodies within IITM? Mention the possible pros and cons of such a collaboration (i.e analyze if your ideas seem viable or not)

7) Can you identify possible collaborations of our guild with any person/club from other IITs (or in general with any organisation outside IITM). Again, mention the possible pros and cons of such a collaboration.

***Note: Your answers for this section must be consistent with your proposed timeline***

## III) COMPETITIONS

1) Give a performance analysis (highlighting areas where we lacked) of the competitions we participated in as a guild this year and why we did not participate in some of the competitions we targeted. How will you improve our performance for this tenure as well as the next? *Talking to fellow participants is recommended.*

2) Institutes like IITB, IITK and CMI have consistently been performing in all the competitions we target (SMMC, Mimamsa, Inter-IIT, etc.). Do you believe we have as many talented people as them? Is our training up to the mark? Do we lack a culture of problem solving?

3) This is the 2nd tenure of the Mathematics guild. How has our performance been so far in comparison to last year (i.e have we improved or performed worse?). Does your opinion match that of others (eg. ex or current guild members, club members / leads, etc)?

4) What competitions did you personally participate in (and if you missed some, what were the reasons for the same)?

5) Should it be compulsory for guild members to participate in competitions conducted by the Mathematics Club (why or why not?). If yes, how would you ensure this happens?

6) Did all members of the guild participate in the **SMMC**? How was our performance and how well do you think we prepared? A lot of competitions happen near quizzes or in the vacations, but are of very good quality. How will you i) Improve turnout when guild members have a busy schedule, ii) Prevent clashes with any institute event / exam (if possible)?

7) Unless a PHD level open problem shows up, only two members of the guild will be able to participate in the **Inter-IIT Tech Meet**.
    - What selection criteria will you use and when will the preparation take place? (to answer this effectively, you need to

elaborate on the kind of prep needed and how many people / resources we should put in) Would you consider taking people outside the guild (i.e is there a reason to?)

- Do you believe the plan used in 2025 was flawed? If yes, mention why and suggest a better approach. How will you ensure commitment from your guild members when a majority of them will not get to attend the competition?

## IV) SRMC 2026

1) Do a detailed SWOT analysis on SRMC 2025.

2) What do you think your responsibilities will be as part of the organising team, i.e how do you think they should be shared with the club heads or how much of a role do you think a Guild Lead should play?

## V) HR and Recruitment

1) Analyze the recruitment process of the last two tenures and point out any issues we faced or somewhere we lacked. Do you think we should have a rolling style guild (i.e we retain current members who wish to stay) or do you feel we should have a fresh recruitment where everyone apps again?

2) Categorize guild members in batches (based on year as well as how much experience they have in the guild). What role do you think guild members of different experience play and what responsibilities do you expect from them as leads?

3) Based on the above question, what do you think should be the ideal structure for the contingent? How to achieve balance between retaining experience and recruiting new talent? What are the disadvantages to having too many or too few of either and where

does the balance lie? Elaborate with total numbers and batch-wise numbers.

4) Propose a recruitment plan for next tenure (May onwards), how many rounds, when and what group will you be targeting with each round? Also ideate on the nature of the recruitment (app, live contest or something else) and make sure your style matches what you expect from your guild members. Consider the logistical challenges of your solution as well (your recruitment plan must also be in the timeline.)

5) Do you think the guild has gone inactive during the winter? Does this impact 25B recruits who are yet to have their first assignment with the guild? What should we do to make amends moving forwards and how will you prevent such a situation moving forwards?